Sim Racing Track Guides

SUZUKA TRACK GUIDE FOR SIM RACING – HOW TO MASTER JAPAN GP

Post by DIY Sim Studio 30 August 2024 0 Comments

Suzuka, located in Suzuka, Japan, is one of the most revered and challenging tracks in motorsport. Known for its unique figure-eight layout, fast corners, and technical sections, Suzuka has been a staple in **Formula 1, Moto GP,** and many other series. The circuit's demanding nature requires a perfect blend of precision, speed, and strategy to excel. But it will no longer hold any secrets for you after reading our **Suzuka track guide**.

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IS SUZUKA A DIFFICULT TRACK?

Suzuka is a high-speed, technical circuit that tests every aspect of a driver's skill. The **track's figure-eight design**, featuring a crossover bridge, creates a unique challenge with a mix of fast, flowing corners and slow, technical sections.

So yes, the circuit is quite technical and it will take you quite a few hours to master it.

WHAT ARE THE CHARACTERISTICS OF THE SUZUKA CIRCUIT?

The elevation **changes, particularly through the** S Curves and the Dunlop Curve, add an extra layer of difficulty. Suzuka demands a well-balanced car setup that can handle both the high-speed corners and the slower, more technical parts of the track.

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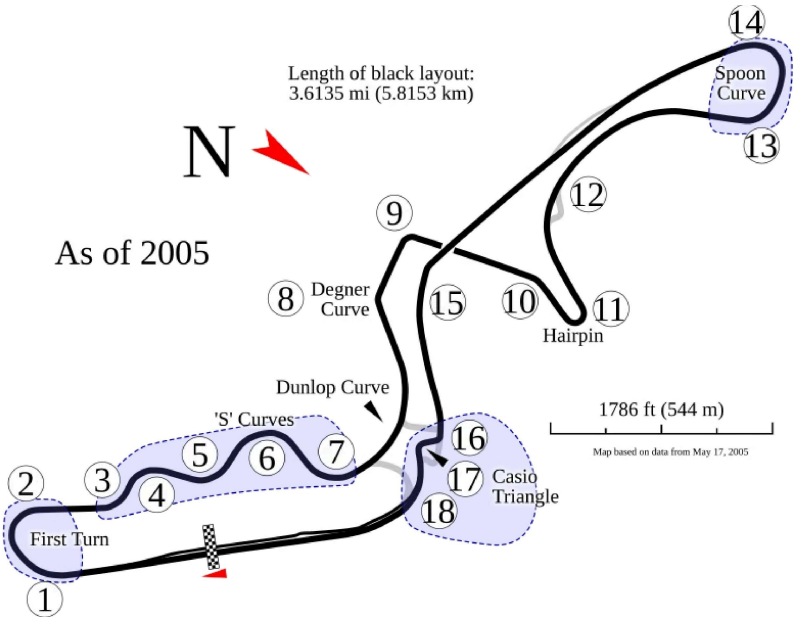
SUZUKA CIRCUIT MAP



SUZUKA CIRCUIT INFO

- **Length:** 5.807 km (3.608 miles)
- **Corners:** 18
- **Notable Sections:** S Curves, Degner Curves, Spoon Curve, 130R, Casio Triangle
- **Lap Record:** 1:30.983 (Lewis Hamilton, Mercedes W10, 2019, F1)

Suzuka Official Website: https://www.suzukacircuit.jp/eng/f1/

SUZUKA TURN NAMES

FIRST CURVE (TURN 1)

- **Corner type:** fast right-hand corner
- **Braking point:** light braking or lift before turn-in
- **Apex speed:** 210-230 km/h (130-143 mph)
- **Tips:** the First Curve is fast and requires commitment. Brake gently or lift off the throttle before turn-in, and focus on a smooth line through the apex. It's important to position the car well for the Second Curve.

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SECOND CURVE (TURN 2)

- **Corner type:** tight right-hand corner
- **Braking point:** hard braking just after the apex of the First Curve
- **Apex speed:** 90-110 km/h (56-68 mph)
- **Tips:** the Second Curve is a tight right-hander that leads into the S Curves. Brake hard and use a late apex to get back on the power early. A clean exit here is crucial for setting up the flow through the S Curves.

S CURVES (TURNS 3-7)

- **Corner type:** fast left-right-left-right-left sequence
- **Braking point:** light braking or lift before each change of direction
- **Apex speed:** 150-170 km/h (93-106 mph) through the first few curves, slower through the last two
- **Tips:** the S Curves are all about rhythm and precision. Maintain a smooth, flowing line through this section, using light throttle and braking inputs to keep the car balanced. Avoid oversteer, as it can disrupt your line and cost you time.

DUNLOP CURVE SUZUKA

- **Corner type:** long, fast left-hand curve
- **Braking point:** slight lift before turn-in
- **Apex speed:** 170-190 km/h (106-118 mph)
- **Tips:** the Dunlop Curve is a long, uphill left-hander that's taken at high speed. Focus on maintaining momentum and keeping the car stable as you crest the hill. This corner can be tricky if the car is unbalanced, so smooth steering inputs are essential.

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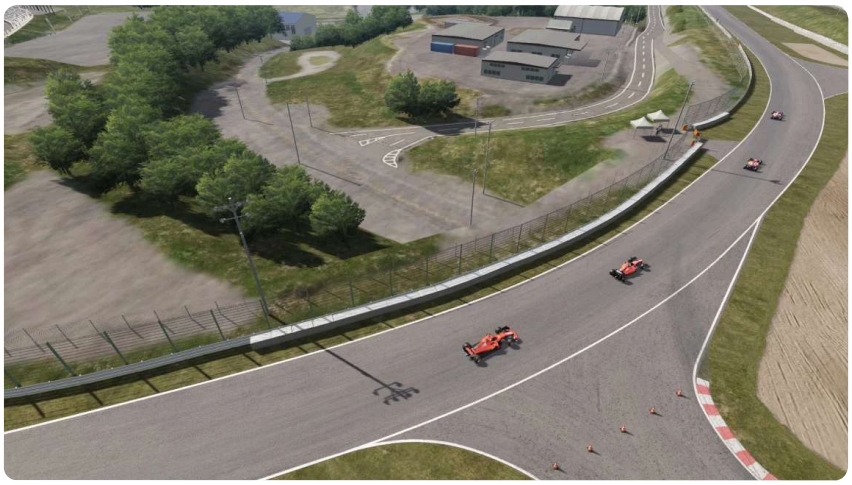
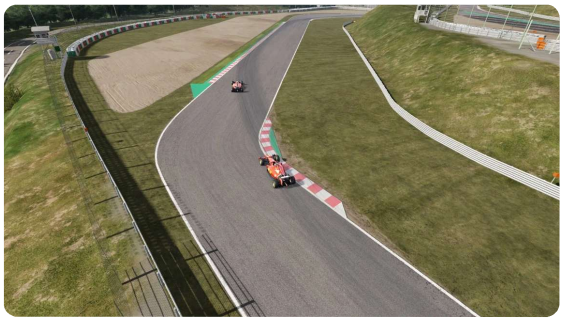


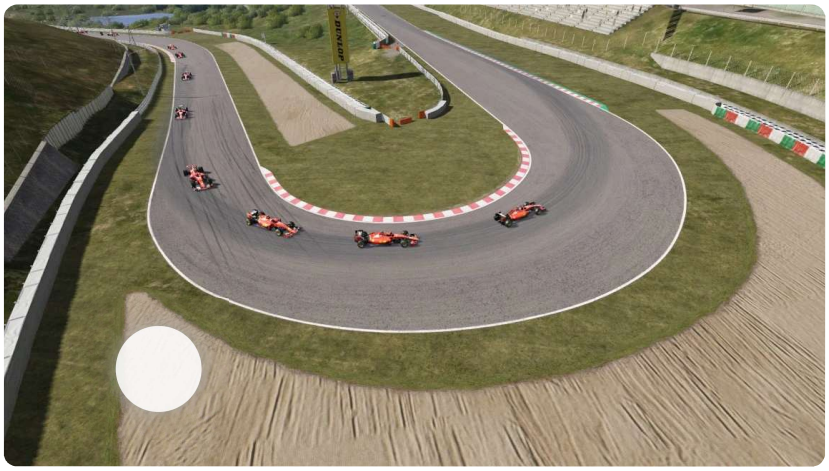
DEGNER CURVES (TURNS 8-9)

- **Corner type:** tight right-hand double-apex corners
- **Braking point:** Hard braking before the first apex
- **Apex speed:** 110-130 km/h (68-81 mph) through Turn 8, slightly slower through Turn 9
- **Tips:** the Degner Curves are technical and unforgiving. Brake hard before Turn 8 and use a tight line (In F1, you will have to brake a little.). Be careful not to run wide on the exit, as there is little runoff. Turn 9 follows quickly, requiring another precise turn-in. Focus on a good exit to gain speed down the straight leading to the Hairpin.



HAIRPIN (TURN 11)

- **Corner type:** tight left-hand hairpin
- **Braking point:** hard braking at around 100 meters before the corner
- **Apex speed:** 60-80 km/h (37-50 mph)
- **Tips:** the Hairpin is the slowest corner on the track. Brake early and aim for a late apex to maximize traction on exit. This sets you up for the following short straight and Spoon Curve. Be smooth on the throttle to avoid wheelspin.



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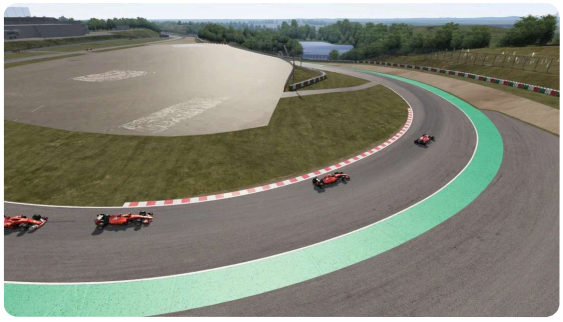
200R (TURN 12)

- **Corner type:** fast right-hand curve
- **Braking point:** no braking, full throttle
- **Apex Speed:** 210-230 km/h (130-143 mph)
- **Tips:** 200R is taken flat out in most cars. Focus on positioning the car well for the approach to Spoon Curve. This is an easy corner, but you need to carry as much speed as possible.

SPOON CURVE (TURNS 13-14)

- **Corner type:** long left-hand double-apex corner
- **Braking point:** light braking before the first apex, harder braking for the second apex
- **Apex speed:** 150-170 km/h (93-106 mph) through the first apex, slower through the second
- **Tips:** Spoon Curve is a long, tricky double-apex corner that requires patience. Brake lightly for the first apex, then harder for the second apex. Focus on a smooth exit as this leads onto the long back straight. Getting a good run out of Spoon is crucial for lap time.



130R (TURN 15)

- **Corner type:** high-speed left-hand corner
- **Braking point:** lift or slight brake before turn-in
- **Apex speed:** 290-310 km/h (180-193 mph)
- **Tips:** 130R is one of the most famous corners in motorsport. It's a fast, sweeping left-hander that requires full commitment. Depending on your car's setup, you may need to lift slightly before turn-in. Focus on hitting the apex and using all the track on exit to maintain speed.

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CASIO TRIANGLE (TURNS 16-18)

- **Corner type:** right-left-right chicane
- **Braking point:** hard braking at around 100 meters before the first apex
- **Apex speed:** 80-100 km/h (50-62 mph)
- **Tips:** the Casio Triangle is the final chicane and the last opportunity to gain or lose time before the finish line. Brake hard and aim for a clean run through the chicane. Use the curbs carefully to rotate the car, but avoid unsettling it too much. Focus on a strong exit to maximize speed down the start/finish straight.

BEST F1 SUZUKA TIPS

- **Qualifying:** a good qualifying position is crucial at Suzuka, as overtaking can be difficult, especially through the narrow sections like the S Curves. Focus on setting a clean, fast lap with minimal traffic interference.
- **Overtaking:** the best overtaking opportunities are into the Hairpin, Spoon Curve, and Casio Triangle. Set up your passes by maximizing exit speed from the preceding corners and use the slipstream on the straights.

HOW TO BE FAST AT SUZUKA?

- **Consistency:** Suzuka rewards smooth, consistent driving. Focus on hitting your marks each lap and avoid overdriving, especially in the technical sections like the S Curves and Degner Curves.
- **Tire management:** tire wear can be significant at Suzuka, particularly through the high-speed corners. Monitor your tire temperatures and adjust your driving style to conserve them when needed, especially in longer races.
- **Nail the Esses (Turns 1-7)**: smooth steering, trail braking into Turn 1, then maintain rhythm and flow through the S-curves. Don't overdrive—precision beats aggression.
- **Dunlop Curve (T7)**: gradual throttle, avoid sliding—momentum is key.

- **Degner 1 & 2 (T8-T9)**: brake hard for Degner 1, short shift to stabilize. Careful throttle out of Degner 2—easy to spin.

SUZUKA TRACK GUIDE – CONCLUSION

Suzuka Circuit is a track that demands **respect, precision, and bravery**. By mastering the key sections, optimizing your car setup, and executing a careful race strategy, you can excel in sim racing at Suzuka.

I hope this **Suzuka track guide** has helped you, you are now ready to compete and beat your opponents in this legendary circuit.

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